GhostBar

Complete Setup & User Guide

AI Sidebar for Mac — Powered by Google Gemini

Support: ghostbarapp@gmail.com

What is GhostBar?



GhostBar puts a floating Google Gemini AI chat panel on EVERY website you open in your browser. Think of it like having a super-smart friend sitting next to you who can read any webpage and answer any question — instantly, without you switching tabs or copy-pasting anything.

You open a website. GhostBar appears on the side. You type a question. You get an answer. That's it.

What can you do with it?

- Ask Gemini to summarize any article or webpage in seconds
- Copy an entire page — including math formulas and images — and ask questions about it
- Get explanations while reading textbooks or research papers
- Draft emails, essays, or answers while browsing
- Works on ANY website — including browsers where you cannot install extensions

> 💡 *GhostBar is a productivity tool. It never stores your conversations, never reads your passwords, and all AI goes directly from your Mac to Google. Your privacy is fully protected.*

Before You Start — Requirements

Make sure you have all of these before installing:

- A Mac computer (Apple Silicon M1/M2/M3 or Intel)
- macOS 12 Monterey or later — if you're not sure, click Apple menu → About This Mac
- Google Chrome, Firefox, or Safari browser
- A free Google account — you already have one if you use Gmail

> ⚠ GhostBar is for Mac only. It does not work on Windows or iPhone.

STEP 1 Install GhostBar

Installing GhostBar takes about 2 minutes. Because GhostBar is sold independently and not through the Apple App Store, macOS shows a security warning. This is completely normal — the same thing happens with many popular apps. You just need to do ONE extra step the very first time.

> ⚠ Do not double-click the DMG file directly — follow these steps in order or you will see an error.

How to install:

1. Download the file called **GhostBar-1.4.0-arm64.dmg** from your Gumroad library
2. Press Cmd+Space on your keyboard at the same time — a search bar appears
3. Type the word Terminal and press Enter — a black window opens
4. Click inside the black window so it is selected
5. Copy this entire command below — click on it, select all, copy it:

```
xattr -cr ~/Downloads/GhostBar-1.4.0-arm64.dmg && open
~/Downloads/GhostBar-1.4.0-arm64.dmg
```

6. Paste it into the Terminal window by pressing Cmd+V
7. Press Enter — the DMG installer opens automatically
8. A window appears showing GhostBar and an Applications folder — drag GhostBar INTO the Applications folder
9. Wait for the copying to finish, then close the installer window
10. Open Finder → Applications → find GhostBar → double-click it

> 💡 *You will NEVER need to open Terminal again. This one command is only needed the very first time because of macOS security. After this, GhostBar opens like any normal app.*

> 💡 *If Terminal asks for your Mac password, type it and press Enter. You will not see the letters appearing — this is normal, just type and press Enter.*

STEP 2 Enter Your License Key

When GhostBar opens for the first time you will see a purple activation screen asking for a license key. This proves you bought the app and locks it to your Mac so nobody else can use your key.

11. Open the email you received from GhostBar after your purchase — it contains your key
12. Your key looks like this: GHOST-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX
13. Copy the key from the email
14. Click inside the key field in GhostBar and paste it (Cmd+V)
15. Click the Activate button
16. You will see a green success message — you are now activated!

> 💡 *Your key is permanently linked to your Mac. If you delete GhostBar and reinstall it later, just enter the same key again — it will activate instantly.*
>
> ⚠️ Keep your key safe. Do not share it with others. Each key works on ONE Mac only.

STEP 3 Get Your Free Google Gemini API Key

GhostBar uses Google's Gemini AI to answer your questions. To use it, you need a free API key from Google. Think of the API key like a password that lets GhostBar talk to Google's AI on your behalf. Getting it takes about 2 minutes.

> ⚠️ Do not skip this step — without an API key, the AI chat will not work at all.

How to get your free API key:

17. Open your browser and go to this website: aistudio.google.com
18. Sign in with your Google account (same as Gmail)
19. Click Get API key in the top left corner of the page
20. Click the blue button that says Create API key
21. Click Create API key in new project
22. A long key appears starting with the letters AIza — click the copy button next to it
23. Go back to GhostBar — click on the Gemini API Key field

24. Paste your key (Cmd+V)
25. Click the Save button
26. GhostBar shows a green tick — your AI key is saved!

> 💡 *The free key works immediately with no credit card needed. Google gives you 15 requests per minute for free — plenty for normal use.*

Optional But Recommended: Upgrade to Gemini Paid Tier



Do you need to do this? No. Should you? Yes, if you use GhostBar a lot.

Here is the honest difference between free and paid:

Free Tier (what you start with):

- 15 requests per minute maximum
- If you ask questions too fast, you get a 'rate limit' error and have to wait
- Uses Gemini 1.5 Flash model — fast but less smart
- Cost: completely free forever

Paid Tier (optional upgrade):

- 1000+ requests per minute — basically unlimited
- Never see rate limit errors no matter how much you use it
- Uses Gemini 1.5 Pro — smarter, better answers, understands complex content better
- Cost: about $0.001 per request — most people spend less than $1 per month

Google gives you $300 in FREE credits when you add a payment method. That is enough for roughly 300,000 requests — you could use GhostBar every day for years before spending a single dollar of your own money.

How to upgrade (5 minutes):

27. Go to aistudio.google.com — click on your API key
28. Click Enable billing or go to console.cloud.google.com
29. Add your credit or debit card — you will NOT be charged immediately
30. Google applies your $300 free credit automatically
31. Come back to GhostBar — it automatically detects you are on paid tier

32. The tier chip in GhostBar changes from purple (Free) to green (Paid)

> 💡 *GhostBar detects your tier automatically. You do not need to change any settings. Just upgrade Google billing and GhostBar switches to the better model on its own.*

STEP 4 Using GhostBar

Starting GhostBar

33. Open GhostBar from your Applications folder — it appears in your dock
34. You see the GhostBar dashboard with a big green Start button
35. Click Start
36. The status circle turns green — this means GhostBar is running
37. The window will come saying One-Time Certificate Setup
38. Click Trust Certificate Automatically
39. Enter your password
40. And press Update Settings
41. Open any website in your browser
42. You will see the GhostBar AI panel appear on the right side of the webpage

> 💡 *The first time you start GhostBar, your browser may show a security certificate warning. Click Accept or Proceed — this is required for GhostBar to work and is completely safe.*

Chatting with Gemini

43. Look at the right side of any webpage — you will see the GhostBar panel
44. Click in the text box at the bottom of the panel
45. Type your question — for example: What is this article about?
46. Press Enter on your keyboard or click the Send button
47. Gemini reads your question and answers in a few seconds
48. You can keep asking follow-up questions — GhostBar remembers the conversation

> 💡 *GhostBar remembers your last 10 messages. You can say things like explain that more simply or give me an example and it will understand what you mean.*

Copy Page — The Most Powerful Feature

Copy Page is what makes GhostBar special. It captures EVERYTHING on the current webpage — all the text, math formulas, diagrams, and images — and sends it to Gemini. Then you can ask anything about what is on that page.

49. Open any article, textbook page, Wikipedia page, or document in your browser
50. Look at the GhostBar panel on the right side of the page
51. Click the Copy Page button
52. GhostBar scans the entire page — this takes 2-3 seconds
53. You will see a confirmation message that the page was captured
54. Now type your question in the chat — for example: Summarize this in 3 bullet points
55. Or: What are the main steps explained on this page?
56. Or: Solve the problems shown on this page

> 💡 *Copy Page works on math formulas written in LaTeX, diagrams, charts, and images. It is specifically designed for academic and technical content.*
>
> ⚠️ Copy Page sends the page content to Google's Gemini AI. Do not use it on pages with personal passwords or private banking information.

Stopping GhostBar

57. Click the red Stop button inside GhostBar — the AI panel disappears from your browser
58. To hide the GhostBar window without stopping it, click the red X button — it keeps running in the background
59. To completely quit GhostBar, press Cmd+Q on your keyboard, or right-click the GhostBar icon in your dock and click Quit

> 💡 *Clicking the red X just hides the window — GhostBar keeps running. This is normal Mac behavior. Use Cmd+Q to fully quit.*

Troubleshooting — Common Problems

Problem: The AI panel does not appear in my browser

- Check that GhostBar shows a green status — click Start if it is grey
- Refresh the webpage by pressing Cmd+R
- Make sure your browser accepted the security certificate when asked
- Try closing the browser completely and opening it again

Problem: I see a rate limit or quota error in the chat

- This means you sent too many messages too quickly on the free tier
- Wait 60 seconds and try again — it resets automatically

- To never see this error again, upgrade to the Gemini paid tier (see Step 3 above)

Problem: My license key is not working

- Make sure you copied the complete key including all dashes — GHOST-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX
- Do not add spaces before or after the key
- If you got a new Mac, your old key will not work on it — email ghostbarapp@gmail.com to transfer

Problem: GhostBar is asking for my key again after I reinstalled

- This is completely normal — just enter your same key again
- Your key never expires — it will activate instantly

Problem: GhostBar was working but now nothing happens

- Click Stop then Start again in GhostBar
- Refresh your browser page
- Restart GhostBar completely by pressing Cmd+Q and opening it again

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Privacy & Security — What GhostBar Does and Does Not Do

We know privacy matters. Here is exactly what happens when you use GhostBar:

- ✅ Your questions and AI answers go directly from your Mac to Google — GhostBar never sees them
- ✅ GhostBar never stores, logs, or reads your conversations
- ✅ GhostBar never reads your passwords, payment details, or login information
- ✅ Banking websites and HTTPS financial pages are automatically skipped by GhostBar
- ✅ Your license key is stored encrypted on your Mac — we cannot read it
- ❌ We do not collect browsing data
- ❌ We do not sell any data — we do not have any data to sell

> 💡 *All AI processing happens through your own Google API key. This means Google processes your requests, not us. Read Google's privacy policy at ai.google.dev for full details.*

Need Help? Contact Support

We respond to all emails within 24 hours.

Email us at: **ghostbarapp@gmail.com**

When emailing, please include:

- The first 8 characters of your license key so we can find your purchase
- What you were trying to do when the problem happened
- What error message appeared, if any
- Your Mac model and macOS version (Apple menu → About This Mac)



Thank you for using GhostBar!

ghostbarapp@gmail.com